READING ASSIGNMENT – THE CONTEMPORARY WORLD (GEC 006)

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SPAMAST-JAS Extension

ASSIGNED READING:

1. Smith, Olu. "Cultural Contexts in English Language Teaching: Balancing Global Standards with Local Relevance." DOI: 10.9790/0837-3010021628
2. Indigenous Peoples Rights Act (RA 8731)
3. Unit 2 Discussion (PPT attached) – Socio-Cultural Systems

INSTRUCTION:

Read the assigned study, PPT and law critically, with particular attention to how globalization operates through educational standardization, especially in English Language Teaching (ELT). Situate the discussion within major theories of globalization—including *cultural homogenization and resistance*, *glocalization*, and *global power asymmetries*—to understand how global standards shape, constrain, and reconfigure national and local education systems.

As you analyze the text, zoom in on the effects of global standards (e.g., IELTS, TOEFL, CEFR) on *Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Practices (IKSP)*, *local languages*, and *culturally rooted pedagogies (indigenous teaching strategies)*. Examine whether the dominance of internationally benchmarked curricula strengthens global mobility at the cost of indigenous epistemologies, or whether localized adaptations can meaningfully coexist with global comparability.

Your analysis should also be grounded in the Philippine context *(zooming in your personal narrative as a JASenyo and as member of the Indigenous Cultural Minority)*. Evaluate how the Indigenous Peoples' Rights Act (IPRA) functions as a policy tool for protecting and promoting IKSP within formal education. Consider whether IPRA, in its current form, is sufficient to address the pressures of globalization on education, or whether it needs to be revisited or augmented to better support IKSP integration in:

- The K–12 curriculum, and
- CHED Memorandum Circulars governing higher education curriculum design.

In your written response (1–2 pages and least 1000 words), you are expected to move beyond summary by arguing, critiquing, and applying globalization theory to the issues raised in the study, with attention to education as both a site of global integration and cultural contestation.

GUIDE QUESTIONS:

1. How does the study demonstrate the impact of global educational standards on local and indigenous knowledge systems? Which theory of globalization best explains this impact?
2. In what ways can international English standards be seen as instruments of cultural homogenization? How does the author's proposal for localization challenge this process, particularly in relation to IKSP?
3. Using the concept of glocalization, assess whether Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Practices can be meaningfully integrated into globally standardized curricula without being reduced or tokenized.

4. How can the Indigenous Peoples' Rights Act (IPRA) serve as a counterbalance to the dominance of global educational norms? Based on the study, should IPRA be strengthened or revised to better address globalization's pressures on education?
5. Should CHED and the Department of Education revisit their curriculum frameworks to more explicitly integrate IKSP while still meeting global standards? What risks and benefits does this pose in a globalized educational system?

SUBMISSION REMINDER:

1. Support your arguments with specific concepts from the reading and theories discussed in class. Strong responses will demonstrate an understanding of globalization as a complex, uneven process that reshapes education, culture, and power relations rather than simply unifying them.

FORMAT:

1. Font style – Arial
2. Font size – 12
3. Size – A4

DEADLINE: February 10, 2026 at 4:50 PM.

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